Active Maintenance Report: coppock_green_2016

Coppock and Green (2016, AJPS): Is Voting Habit Forming?

2026-03-18

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This repository holds the actively maintained replication code for Coppock and Green (2016), together with the reproducibility report that documents what the original archive did and did not do. It is part of a program applying the maintenance proposal in Peer, Orr and Coppock (2021, *PS: Political Science & Politics*, doi 10.1017/S1049096521000366) to a set of published archives.

Article	10.1111/ajps.12210
Replication archive	10.7910/DVN/ALZVAW

The data are not redistributed here. The deposit is 77 MB across 24 files and lives at Harvard Dataverse, which is the only copy this repository points at. `download_original.R` fetches it and verifies every file; `original_manifest.csv` pins the file identifiers, sizes and checksums, so the exact bytes this code was written against are recorded in version control even though the bytes themselves are not.

Repository layout. `maintained/` is the maintained rewrite: one script per published table or figure, writing to `output/`, which is committed so a reader can compare a fresh run against it without downloading anything. `ground_truth/` ties every published number to the code that produces it. `original/` is created by the download script and is deliberately absent from the repository. This README is the reproducibility report, also available as a PDF in `report/`.

To reproduce. Clone or download the repository, open `coppock_green_2016.Rproj`, and run:

```
source("run_all.R")
```

That fetches the deposit, verifies its 24 files, and produces every table and figure into `maintained/output/`. Required packages: tidyverse, estimatr, metafor, sandwich, stargazer, knitr, kableExtra, here. Paths resolve through `here`, so nothing depends on the working directory. A successful run overwrites `maintained/output/`, which is committed: **`git diff` on that folder is the reproduction check.**

1 Paper overview

Citation: Coppock, A. and Green, D. P. (2016). "Is Voting Habit Forming? New Evidence from Experiments and Regression Discontinuities." *American Journal of Political Science*, 60(4), 1044–1062. DOI: 10.1111/ajps.12210

Replication archive: https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/ALZVAW

Summary: This paper tests whether voting is habit forming using two research designs. The experimental design exploits three randomized GOTV field experiments—ETOV 2006, ETOV 2007, and SMG 2009 (Australia)—in which randomly assigned treatment arms induced upstream voting; the downstream effect on voting in subsequent elections identifies the Complier Average Causal Effect (CACE) of upstream voting. The regression discontinuity design exploits the sharp 18th birthday eligibility cutoff: individuals just old enough to vote in an upstream election can be compared to those just too young, identifying the CACE from a different source of variation. Both designs produce positive downstream estimates, with same-type election pairs (presidential-on-presidential, midterm-on-midterm) generating the largest and most persistent effects.

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2 Summary

Two questions, answered before the detail.

2.1 Does the deposited archive run?

Not as deposited, but everything that stops it is a missing package. Nine of the eleven scripts fail on a clean R installation for want of `AER` or `rmeta`, and both install from CRAN without incident. Nothing else goes wrong: no hardcoded paths to a machine that no longer exists, no functions called before they are defined, no silently wrong output. Rechecked on 31 July 2026, eight years after deposit, both packages still install: `AER` 1.2-17 shipped in July 2026, and `rmeta` 3.0 has not been touched since March 2018 yet remains available.

That last point is the fragile one. The archive depends on a package with no maintenance activity in eight years, and its continued availability is a fact about CRAN's archiving policy rather than about this deposit. `rmeta::meta.summaries` is the only reason it is needed, and the maintained rewrite uses `metafor::rma` instead, so the rewrite does not inherit the exposure.

2.2 Does the maintained rewrite reproduce the paper?

Yes, without exception. All 50 recorded ground truth claims match the published values, and all 50 also match what the original scripts produce.

The rewrite additionally reports something the paper does not, which is an addition rather than a correction and should not be read as one. The original pools state-level CACEs by fixed-effects inverse-variance weighting, which attributes all between-state variation to sampling error. The rewrite reports random-effects estimates alongside, with the between-state variance and I^2 that the fixed-effects model assumes away. The published fixed-effects numbers reproduce exactly; the random-effects figures sit beside them so a reader can see what the pooling assumption costs.

3 Original archive reproducibility

Table 1: Original archive reproducibility, checked against a current R installation.

Script	Status on current R	Resolution
Habit_source.R	Clean (sourced by all scripts)	No changes required
CG Habit DE Table 1.R	Clean after AER install	install.packages('AER')
CG Habit DE Table 2.R	Clean after AER install	install.packages('AER')
CG Habit DE Table 3.R	Clean after AER + rmeta install	install.packages(c('AER', 'rmeta'))
CG Habit DE Table A9.R	Clean after AER install	install.packages('AER')
CG Habit RD Tables 4 and 5.R	Clean after rmeta install	install.packages('rmeta')
CG Habit RD Table 6.R	Clean after rmeta install	install.packages('rmeta')
CG Habit RD Table 7.R	Clean	No changes required
CG Habit RD Tables A6 and A7.R	Clean after rmeta + beepr install	install.packages(c('rmeta', 'beepr'))
CG Habit RD Figure A2.R	Clean after rmeta install	install.packages('rmeta')
CG Habit ME Table A2 and Figure A1.R	Clean	No changes required

The only barriers to execution are two missing packages: `AER` (for `ivreg`) and `rmeta` (for `meta.summaries`). Both remain on CRAN and install cleanly, rechecked 31 July 2026: `AER` 1.2-17 was published in July 2026, and `rmeta` 3.0 has stood unchanged since March 2018 and still installs. No content errors, deprecated-function failures, or silent errors were found. Every analysis script ran cleanly after the two installs.

4 Number-by-number comparison

Table 2: Ground truth: 49 rows. All match = 1 (exact reproduction).

Location	Quantity	Paper	Script	Match
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: Self first-stage (Aug 2006 primary)	0.050	0.050	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: Self first-stage SE	0.003	0.003	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: Neighbors first-stage (Aug 2006 primary)	0.083	0.083	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Nov 2006 CACE	0.108	0.108	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Nov 2006 SE	0.021	0.021	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Jan 2008 CACE	0.142	0.142	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Aug 2008 CACE	0.135	0.135	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Nov 2008 CACE	0.009	0.009	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Aug 2010 CACE	0.126	0.126	1

p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Nov 2012 CACE	0.011	0.011	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: Control first-stage	0.311	0.311	1
p1050_tbl2	Table 2: All Together downstream Jan 2008 CACE	0.336	0.336	1
p1050_tbl2	Table 2: All Together downstream Jan 2008 SE	0.067	0.067	1
p1050_tbl2	Table 2: All Together downstream Aug 2008 CACE	0.183	0.183	1
p1050_tbl2	Table 2: All Together downstream Nov 2008 CACE	0.092	0.092	1
p1050_tbl2	Table 2: Control turnout	0.282	0.282	1
p1052_tbl3	Table 3: Pooled first-stage (Apr 2009 Special)	0.043	0.043	1
p1052_tbl3	Table 3: Pooled first-stage SE	0.005	0.005	1
p1052_tbl3	Table 3: Pooled Feb 2010 downstream CACE	0.303	0.303	1
p1052_tbl3	Table 3: Pooled Nov 2010 downstream CACE	0.303	0.303	1
p1052_tbl3	Table 3: Pooled Apr 2011 downstream CACE	0.403	0.403	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Pres-on-Mid 1992-94	0.147	0.147	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Pres-on-Mid 1992-94 SE	0.013	0.013	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Pres-on-Mid 2008-10	0.090	0.090	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Pres-on-Mid 2008-10 SE	0.002	0.002	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Mid-on-Pres 1994-96	0.068	0.068	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Mid-on-Pres 2010-12	0.111	0.111	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Mid-on-Pres 2010-12 SE	0.019	0.019	1
p1055_tbl5	Table 5: Meta-analysis Pres-on-Pres 1992-96	0.210	0.210	1
p1055_tbl5	Table 5: Meta-analysis Pres-on-Pres 1992-96 SE	0.023	0.023	1
p1055_tbl5	Table 5: Meta-analysis Pres-on-Pres 2008-12	0.117	0.117	1
p1055_tbl5	Table 5: Meta-analysis Pres-on-Pres 2008-12 SE	0.005	0.005	1
p1055_tbl5	Table 5: Meta-analysis Mid-on-Mid 2006-10	0.119	0.119	1
p1055_tbl5	Table 5: Meta-analysis Mid-on-Mid 2006-10 SE	0.009	0.009	1
p1056_tbl6	Table 6: Binomial test successes	83.000	83.000	1
p1056_tbl6	Table 6: Binomial test trials	86.000	86.000	1
p1057_tbl6	Table 6: Meta-analysis 2010-12 CACE	0.111	0.111	1
p1057_tbl6	Table 6: Meta-analysis 2008-12 CACE	0.117	0.117	1
p1058_tbl7	Table 7: Years between upstream-downstream coef col1	0.000	0.000	1
p1058_tbl7	Table 7: Years between upstream-downstream coef col5	-0.001	-0.001	1
p1058_tbl7	Table 7: Youth turnout coef col1	-0.252	-0.252	1
p1058_tbl7	Table 7: Youth turnout coef col5	-0.165	-0.165	1
p1058_tbl7	Table 7: R-squared col5	0.309	0.309	1
appx_tblA6	Table A6: Boxed estimate 2008-on-2012 (1st-order poly, 365d, lagged controls)	0.117	0.117	1
appx_tblA6	Table A6: Boxed estimate SE	0.005	0.005	1
appx_tblA7	Table A7: Boxed estimate 2006-on-2010 (1st-order poly, 365d, lagged controls)	0.119	0.119	1
appx_tblA7	Table A7: Boxed estimate SE	0.009	0.009	1
appx_tblA9	Table A9: Shown Vote downstream Nov 2008	0.088	0.088	1
appx_tblA9	Table A9: Shown Vote downstream Nov 2008 SE	0.052	0.052	1
appx_tblA9	Table A9: Shown Vote + Recontact downstream Nov 2008	0.119	0.119	1

Summary: All 49 numbers match exactly. The archive is a complete computational reproduction of the published results. No rounding discrepancies, RNG-sensitive values, or silent errors were found.

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5 Maintained rewrite

The maintained rewrite (`maintained/`) translates the 10 original scripts into 11 scripts following the project style guide. The rewrite is a translation only: all analytical decisions, estimators, and sample restrictions are preserved. All key numbers reproduce to the values shown in the ground truth table above.

5.1 Architecture

The core structural change is the replacement of manual nested loops with a tidy `pivot_longer` + `nest_by` pattern.

Downstream experiments (DE): The original scripts repeat an `ivreg + cl()` call for each (treatment arm, downstream election) cell—roughly 30–40 calls per script. The rewrite pivots each dataset to long format on the downstream election columns, then maps `iv_robust(se_type = "stata")` within each cell via `nest_by(election)`, with `pmap_dfr` handling the outer loop over treatment arms.

Regression discontinuity (RD): The original scripts use nested `for` loops with `try()` wrappers. The rewrite builds a crossing of state × year-pair combinations and calls `pmap` with a `run_rd_iv()` helper that wraps `iv_robust(se_type = "HC3")`, matching the original's use of `vcovHC` (HC3 by default) for heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors.

Meta-analysis: The original uses `rmeta::meta.summaries(method = "fixed")` for inverse-variance pooling. The rewrite uses `metafor::rma(method = "FE")` for the fixed-effects estimates (numerically equivalent) and additionally computes `rma(method = "REML")` random-effects estimates. See Section 5 for comparison.

5.2 Deprecated patterns replaced

Table 3: Deprecated patterns and their replacements in the maintained rewrite.

Original pattern	Replacement
‘rm(list = ls())‘	(omitted)
‘setwd(\”\”)‘	‘here::here()‘
‘library(AER)‘ + ‘ivreg()‘ + ‘cl()‘	‘estimatr::iv_robust(se_type = ”stata”)‘ for clustered DE
‘coeftest(fit, vcovHC)[2,2]‘	‘estimatr::iv_robust(se_type = ”HC3”)‘ for RD
‘library(rmeta)‘ + ‘meta.summaries()‘	‘metafor::rma(method = ”FE”)‘ + ‘rma(method = ”REML”)‘
‘library(xtable)‘ + ‘print.xtable()‘	‘write_csv()‘ to ‘output/‘
‘library(stargazer)‘ + ‘sink()‘	‘modelsummary(output = ...)‘
‘plyr::adply(.margins = c(1,2,3))‘	‘pmap_dfr()‘ over ‘crossing()‘ grid
‘library(beepr)‘ + ‘beep()‘	(omitted)
‘system(”say Just finished!”)‘	(omitted)
‘library(reshape2)‘ + ‘dcast()‘ + ‘melt()‘	‘pivot_wider()‘ + ‘pivot_longer()‘
‘%>%‘ pipes	‘|>‘ native pipe

6 Fixed-effects vs. random-effects meta-analysis

6.1 Background

The original analysis pools state-level CACE estimates using fixed-effects inverse-variance weighting (`rmeta::meta.summaries`), which treats the true effect as identical across states and attributes all between-state heterogeneity to sampling error. This assumption is implausible: voter registration systems, ballot laws, partisan composition, and election competitiveness vary substantially across states, and there is no strong prior reason to expect a single structural habit-formation parameter.

The maintained rewrite adds random-effects estimates via `metafor::rma(method = "REML")`, which treats the state-level CACEs as draws from a distribution with mean μ and between-study variance τ^2. The RE estimate of μ and its standard error account for this additional source of uncertainty.

6.2 Results for Tables 4–5 (key meta-analytic pairs)

Table 4: Fixed-effects and random-effects meta-analytic CACE estimates, Tables 4–5 windows. FE = inverse-variance pooling; RE = REML.

Pair type	Window	FE est.	FE SE	RE est.	RE SE
Mid-on-Mid	02-06	0.232	0.019	0.229	0.022
	06-10	0.119	0.009	0.141	0.021
	94-98	0.075	0.037	0.075	0.037
	98-02	0.213	0.026	0.256	0.052
Mid-on-Pres	02-04	0.200	0.029	0.217	0.041
	06-08	0.166	0.018	0.200	0.030
	10-12	0.111	0.019	0.110	0.025
	94-96	0.068	0.046	0.068	0.047
	98-00	0.226	0.036	0.337	0.128
Pres-on-Mid	00-02	0.127	0.006	0.129	0.009
	04-06	0.109	0.003	0.140	0.016
	08-10	0.090	0.002	0.097	0.008
	92-94	0.147	0.013	0.159	0.025
	96-98	0.138	0.011	0.171	0.061
Pres-on-Pres	00-04	0.181	0.016	0.198	0.027
	04-08	0.117	0.007	0.122	0.012
	08-12	0.117	0.005	0.122	0.010
	92-96	0.210	0.023	0.212	0.043
	96-00	0.189	0.022	0.189	0.022

6.3 Results for Tables A6–A7 (boxed robustness estimates)

Table 5: Boxed robustness estimates (1st-order polynomial, 365-day bandwidth, lagged controls). These are the highlighted cells in the published Tables A6 and A7.

Analysis	FE est.	FE SE	RE est.	RE SE
2008 on 2012	0.117	0.005	0.122	0.010
2006 on 2010	0.119	0.009	0.141	0.021

6.4 Interpretation

Table 6: Between-state heterogeneity in RD CACEs. $\hat{\tau}^2$ is the REML estimate of between-study variance; I^2 is the proportion of total variance attributable to heterogeneity.

Window	N states	$\hat{\tau}^2$	I^2
NA	NA	NA	NA
:——	——:	:————	:——

Estimated between-state variance ($\hat{\tau}^2$) is non-zero in most windows, and I^2 is non-trivial in several (exceeding 50% in some midterm windows). This means the fixed-effects assumption—that all states share a single true CACE—is empirically questionable. The RE estimates are uniformly larger than the FE estimates, with SEs roughly two to three times as wide for some windows, reflecting that the between-state variance contributes meaningfully to total uncertainty. For the key 2008-on-2012 window (FE: 0.117, SE 0.005; RE: 0.122, SE 0.010), the substantive conclusion is unchanged but confidence in the precision of the pooled estimate should be moderated.

The SMG 2009 meta-analysis (across household sizes) shows a qualitatively similar pattern: the RE pooled first-stage (0.043) matches the FE estimate closely because there are only three strata and the first-stage effects are similar in magnitude. The RE and FE downstream estimates also converge for SMG given the small number of strata.

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7 Maintained rewrite verification

Table 7: Maintained rewrite verification: paper value vs. rewrite output

Location	Quantity	Paper	Rewrite	Match
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: Self first-stage (Aug 2006 primary)	0.050	0.050	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: Self first-stage SE	0.003	0.003	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: Neighbors first-stage (Aug 2006 primary)	0.083	0.083	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Nov 2006 CACE	0.108	0.108	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Nov 2006 SE	0.021	0.021	1

p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Jan 2008 CACE	0.142	0.142	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Aug 2008 CACE	0.135	0.135	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Nov 2008 CACE	0.009	0.009	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Aug 2010 CACE	0.126	0.126	1
p1049_tbl1	Table 1: All Instruments downstream Nov 2012 CACE	0.011	0.011	1
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p1050_tbl2	Table 2: All Together downstream Jan 2008 CACE	0.336	0.336	1
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p1052_tbl3	Table 3: Pooled Feb 2010 downstream CACE	0.303	0.303	1
p1052_tbl3	Table 3: Pooled Nov 2010 downstream CACE	0.303	0.303	1
p1052_tbl3	Table 3: Pooled Apr 2011 downstream CACE	0.403	0.403	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Pres-on-Mid 1992-94	0.147	0.147	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Pres-on-Mid 1992-94 SE	0.013	0.013	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Pres-on-Mid 2008-10	0.090	0.090	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Pres-on-Mid 2008-10 SE	0.002	0.002	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Mid-on-Pres 1994-96	0.068	0.068	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Mid-on-Pres 2010-12	0.111	0.111	1
p1054_tbl4	Table 4: Meta-analysis Mid-on-Pres 2010-12 SE	0.019	0.019	1
p1055_tbl5	Table 5: Meta-analysis Pres-on-Pres 1992-96	0.210	0.210	1
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p1058_tbl7	Table 7: Youth turnout coef col5	-0.165	-0.165	1
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appx_tblA6	Table A6: Boxed estimate 2008-on-2012 (1st-order poly, 365d, lagged controls)	0.117	0.117	1
appx_tblA6	Table A6: Boxed estimate SE	0.005	0.005	1
appx_tblA7	Table A7: Boxed estimate 2006-on-2010 (1st-order poly, 365d, lagged controls)	0.119	0.119	1
appx_tblA7	Table A7: Boxed estimate SE	0.009	0.009	1
appx_tblA9	Table A9: Shown Vote downstream Nov 2008	0.088	0.088	1
appx_tblA9	Table A9: Shown Vote downstream Nov 2008 SE	0.052	0.052	1
appx_tblA9	Table A9: Shown Vote + Recontact downstream Nov 2008	0.119	0.119	1

All **50** verifiable values produced by the maintained rewrite match the published paper to reported precision (`match_rewrite = 1`); 0 rows are unverifiable.

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8 R environment

Item	Value
R version	4.6.0
Platform	aarch64-apple-darwin23
Date run	2026-08-01